



**Pace clincher:** India's six-run win at The Oval, its narrowest in Tests, came through Mohammed Siraj, Prasidh Krishna, and Akash Deep, consigning England to its joint-third-narrowest defeat. AFP

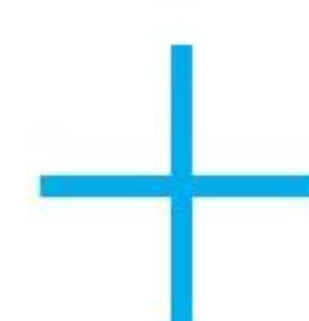
bowled out for 367.

Concerns over India's slip cordon emerged in the opener at Leeds, where several chances went down. Fielding coach T. Dilip responded by shuffling the slip arrangement and increasing close-in drills in training. Recognising the importance of sharp fielding against England, players like Rahul, Karun Nair, Jaiswal and B. Sai Sudharsan spent at least an extra hour honing their slip catching by the end of the tour.

There were however question marks at No. 3, with neither Karun nor Sudharsan converting starts into big scores. Yet they built valuable

partnerships, easing pressure on the middle order. Some selection calls were questionable. Kuldeep Yadav sat out at Old Trafford and Edgbaston, where wrist-spin could have been an asset, and Abhimanyu Easwaran was not given a chance, spending the tour carrying drinks.

**In the end, such issues faded in importance. The Indian team displayed skill, resilience and unity, promising a brighter future.** This was not only about the result; it was about how a group of young, relatively inexperienced players came together to make themselves a team to beat.



## Roll of honour

**Player Of The Match At The Oval**  
**Mohammed Siraj**

4/86 & 5/104

**India's Player Of The Series**  
**Shubman Gill**

Runs: 754; Innings: 10;  
Average: 75.40

**England's Player Of The Series**  
**Harry Brook**

Runs: 481; Innings: 9;  
Average: 53.44